

Jeff's transition from full-time to part-time work took three years to complete. He said going part-time was his worst financial decision because a physician's ability to generate income is their greatest asset. Still, he said it was a really great personal decision. He also noted that because of other changes he made during the transition to part-time work, he became much happier even while still working full-time.

Brandon, who writes *The Mad Fientist* blog, shared a similar story of unhappiness on his path to FI. I related to his story on an intensely personal level. *The Mad Fientist* was one of the first blogs I ever read, and I still read every word Brandon writes. I credit his blog with simplifying the US tax code for me and making it interesting, things I previously thought were impossible. His writing helped me optimize my path to FI, giving me years of additional financial freedom by making simple planning changes.

Brandon's writing changed my life for the better, but reading his blog was also the biggest reason for my unhappiness on the path to FI. He frequently wrote about optimizing the path to FI with the underlying assumptions that once you achieve FI and retire, your life will dramatically improve. The sooner you get there, the better. Comparing my investing and tax planning mistakes against his